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一、全文主旨

中文主旨

本文围绕战后日本传统工作道德价值观衰退的核心现象展开，深入分析了该现象出现的三大诱因：战后婴儿潮一代成年与女性进入职场挤压了青少年的发展空间、应试教育体系对创造力与人格培养的长期忽视、城市化带来的生活方式剧变对传统家庭与社群价值观的冲击；同时指出了该现象引发的学生与职场人高不满度、校园暴力频发、离婚率与自杀率大幅攀升等一系列社会问题。

英文主旨

This article focuses on the core phenomenon of the decline of traditional work-moral values in post-war Japan, and deeply analyzes three major causes of this phenomenon: the coming of age of the post-war baby boomers and women's entry into the workplace squeezing young people's development space, the long-term neglect of creativity and personality cultivation by the exam-oriented education system, and the impact of dramatic lifestyle changes brought by urbanization on traditional family and community values. It also points out a series of social problems caused by this phenomenon, including high dissatisfaction of students and workers, frequent school violence, and a sharp rise in divorce rate and suicide rate.

二、逐段逐句精读解析

第一段

逐句翻译、词汇与长难句分析

1. 原文：Aimlessness has hardly been typical of the postwar Japan whose productivity and social harmony are the envy of the United States and Europe.

- 译文：漫无目标几乎从来都不是战后日本的典型特征，其生产力水平与社会和谐程度令美国和欧洲各国艳羡不已。
- 常考单词&短语：
 - aimlessness n. 漫无目标，无方向感
 - hardly adv. 几乎不，几乎没有（表否定含义，考研高频考点词）
 - typical adj. 典型的，有代表性的；固定搭配 **be typical of** 是...的典型特征
 - postwar adj. 战后的
 - productivity n. 生产力，生产率
 - social harmony 社会和谐
 - envy n. 羡慕，令人羡慕的人/事物；固定搭配 **the envy of sb** 令某人羡慕的对象

- 长难句结构分析：

本句为带限制性定语从句的复合句。主句为 **Aimlessness has hardly been typical of the postwar Japan**；**whose** 引导定语从句，先行词为 **postwar Japan**，**whose** 在从句中作定语修饰 **productivity and social harmony**，从句主干为 **whose productivity and social harmony are the envy of the United States and Europe**。

2. 原文：But increasingly the Japanese are seeing a decline of the traditional work-moral values.

- 译文：但如今，日本人正愈发见证着传统工作道德价值观的衰退。
- 常考单词&短语：
 - increasingly adv. 越来越多地，日益
 - see v. 见证，经历；目睹（此处为熟词生义，考研高频考点）

- decline n. 衰退, 下降, 衰落
- traditional adj. 传统的
- work-moral values 工作道德价值观

3. 原文: Ten years ago young people were hardworking and saw their jobs as their primary reason for being, but now Japan has largely fulfilled its economic needs, and young people don't know where they should go next.

- 译文: 十年前, 年轻人勤奋肯干, 将工作视为自己生存的首要意义, 但如今, 日本的经济需求已基本得到满足, 年轻人却不知道自己接下来该何去何从。
- 常考单词&短语:
 - hardworking adj. 勤奋的, 肯干的
 - 固定搭配 see...as... 把...视为...
 - primary adj. 首要的, 主要的; 初级的
 - reason for being 生存的意义, 存在的理由
 - largely adv. 很大程度上, 基本, 主要地
 - fulfill v. 满足, 实现; 履行
 - economic needs 经济需求

○ 长难句结构分析:

本句为 but 连接的并列复合句。前半分句 Ten years ago young people were hardworking and saw their jobs as their primary reason for being 为并列谓语结构, were hardworking 与 saw their jobs as... 为两个并列的谓语; 后半分句由 and 连接两个并列句, 其中第二个并列句包含 where 引导的宾语从句, 作 know 的宾语。

本段核心概括

本段先通过对比, 指出战后日本曾凭借高生产力与社会和谐度被欧美国家艳羡, 绝非漫无目标的国家, 随后点明全文核心论题——日本传统工作道德价值观正日益衰退, 并通过十年前后的今昔对比, 说明经济需求基本满足后日本年轻人失去人生方向的现状。

第二段

逐句翻译、词汇与长难句分析

1. 原文: The coming of age of the postwar baby boom and an entry of women into the male-dominated job market have limited the opportunities of teen-agers who are already questioning the heavy personal sacrifices involved in climbing Japan's rigid social ladder to good schools and jobs.

- 译文: 战后婴儿潮一代步入成年, 加之女性进入原本由男性主导的就业市场, 这两大因素限制了青少年的发展机会, 而这些青少年已然在质疑, 为了攀上日本通往好学校、好工作的僵化社会阶梯, 所要付出的沉重个人代价是否值得。
- 常考单词&短语:
 - coming of age 成年, 达到法定年龄
 - baby boom 婴儿潮
 - entry n. 进入, 加入; 固定搭配 entry into 进入...
 - male-dominated adj. 男性主导的, 男权的
 - job market 就业市场, 职场
 - limit v. 限制, 限定
 - teen-agers n. 青少年, 十几岁的年轻人
 - question v. 质疑, 怀疑; 询问 (此处为动词用法, 考研高频考点)
 - heavy adj. 沉重的, 巨大的
 - personal sacrifice 个人牺牲
 - 固定搭配 be involved in 涉及, 与...相关; 包含在...之中

- rigid adj. 僵化的，死板的；严格的
- social ladder 社会阶梯
- 长难句结构分析：

本句为多重复合句，主句主干为 The coming of age of the postwar baby boom and an entry of women into the male-dominated job market have limited the opportunities of teenagers，主语为 and 连接的两个并列名词短语。who 引导限制性定语从句，先行词为 teenagers，从句主干为 who are already questioning the heavy personal sacrifices；过去分词短语 involved in climbing Japan's rigid social ladder to good schools and jobs 作后置定语，修饰 personal sacrifices。
- 2. 原文：In a recent survey, it was found that only 24.5 percent of Japanese students were fully satisfied with school life, compared with 67.2 percent of students in the United States.
 - 译文：近期一项调查显示，仅有24.5%的日本学生对校园生活完全满意，而美国学生的这一比例高达67.2%。
 - 常考单词&短语：
 - survey n. 调查，民意调查
 - 固定句型 it was found that... 研究/调查发现...
 - percent n. 百分比，百分数
 - fully adv. 完全地，充分地
 - 固定搭配 be satisfied with 对...感到满意
 - 固定搭配 compared with 与...相比，相较之下
- 3. 原文：In addition, far more Japanese workers expressed dissatisfaction with their jobs than did their counterparts in the 10 other countries surveyed.
 - 译文：此外，与其他10个被调查国家的从业者相比，对自身工作表示不满的日本劳动者数量要多得多。
 - 常考单词&短语：
 - 固定搭配 in addition 此外，另外
 - far more 多得多，远不止
 - express v. 表达，表示
 - dissatisfaction n. 不满，不满意（反义词 satisfaction）
 - counterpart n. 对应的人/物，同行，同职位的人（考研高频考点词）
 - surveyed adj. 被调查的（过去分词作后置定语）
 - 长难句结构分析：

本句为比较状语从句，主句为 far more Japanese workers expressed dissatisfaction with their jobs；than 引导比较状语从句，从句使用了倒装结构，正常语序为 than their counterparts in the 10 other countries surveyed did，did 替代前文的 expressed dissatisfaction with their jobs，避免重复；句末 surveyed 为过去分词作后置定语，修饰 10 other countries。

本段核心概括

本段分析了日本年轻人价值观衰退的第一个核心原因：婴儿潮一代成年、女性进入职场两大因素挤压了青少年的就业与发展空间，使其对为升学就业付出的沉重个人牺牲产生了强烈质疑；同时用两组跨国调查数据佐证，日本学生对校园生活、日本劳动者对工作的不满程度远高于其他被调查国家。

第三段

逐句翻译、词汇与长难句分析

1. 原文: While often praised by foreigners for its emphasis on the basics, Japanese education tends to stress test taking and mechanical learning over creativity and self-expression.

- 译文: 尽管日本的教育因重视基础教育而常受到外国人的称赞, 但它往往更强调应试和机械性学习, 而非创造力与自我表达能力的培养。
- 常考单词&短语:
 - while conj. 尽管, 虽然 (此处表让步, 考研高频考点); 当...时
 - praise v. 称赞, 表扬; 固定搭配 **praise sb for sth** 因某事称赞某人
 - emphasis n. 重视, 强调; 固定搭配 **emphasis on** 对...的重视
 - basics n. 基础, 基础知识, 基础教育
 - 固定搭配 **tend to** 往往, 倾向于
 - stress v. 强调, 重视
 - test taking 应试, 考试应对
 - mechanical learning 机械学习, 死记硬背
 - over prep. 而不是, 优先于
 - creativity n. 创造力, 创造性
 - self-expression n. 自我表达, 自我表现

长难句结构分析:

本句为让步状语从句的省略结构, 完整从句为 **while Japanese education is often praised by foreigners for its emphasis on the basics**, 当主从句主语一致且从句包含be动词时, 可省略从句的主语和be动词。主句主干为 **Japanese education tends to stress A over B**, 其中A为 **test taking and mechanical learning**, B为 **creativity and self-expression**。

2. 原文: "Those things that do not show up in the test scores — personality, ability, courage or humanity — are completely ignored," says Toshiki Kaifu, chairman of the ruling Liberal Democratic Party's education committee.

- 译文: "那些无法在考试分数中体现出来的东西——个性、能力、勇气或是人文素养——被完全忽视了," 日本执政的自由民主党教育委员会主席海部俊树说道。
- 常考单词&短语:
 - 固定搭配 **show up** 显现, 体现; 出现, 露面
 - test score 考试分数, 成绩
 - personality n. 个性, 人格
 - humanity n. 人文素养, 人性, 人道
 - completely adv. 完全地, 彻底地
 - ignore v. 忽视, 忽略, 不理睬
 - ruling adj. 执政的, 统治的
 - Liberal Democratic Party (日本) 自由民主党
 - committee n. 委员会

长难句结构分析:

本句为倒装的直接引语句, 正常语序为 **Toshiki Kaifu, chairman of the ruling Liberal Democratic Party's education committee, says + 直接引语**。引语部分主干为 **Those things are completely ignored**; **that** 引导定语从句修饰先行词 **Those things**; 破折号之间的内容为插入语, 对 **Those things** 进行举例说明; 句末的 **chairman of...committee** 是 **Toshiki Kaifu** 的同位语, 补充说明其身份。

3. 原文: "Frustration against this kind of thing leads kids to drop out and run wild."

- 译文: "对这种情况的挫败感, 会导致孩子们辍学、肆意妄为。"

○ 常考单词&短语:

- frustration n. 挫败感, 沮丧, 失意
- 固定搭配 **lead sb to do sth** 导致某人做某事, 使某人做某事
- 固定搭配 **drop out** 辍学, 退出
- 固定搭配 **run wild** 肆意妄为, 撒野, 失控

4. 原文: Last year Japan experienced 2, 125 incidents of school violence, including 929 assaults on teachers.

○ 译文: 去年, 日本共发生了2125起校园暴力事件, 其中包括929起袭击教师的案件。

○ 常考单词&短语:

- experience v. 经历, 遭遇
- incident n. 事件, 事变
- school violence 校园暴力
- including prep. 包括
- assault n. 袭击, 攻击; 固定搭配 **assault on sb** 对某人的袭击

5. 原文: Amid the outcry, many conservative leaders are seeking a return to the prewar emphasis on moral education.

○ 译文: 在一片抗议声中, 许多保守派领导人正寻求回归战前对道德教育的重视模式。

○ 常考单词&短语:

- amid prep. 在...之中, 在...的背景下
- outcry n. 强烈抗议, 公众呐喊, 哗然
- conservative adj. 保守的, 保守派的
- seek v. 寻求, 谋求
- 固定搭配 **return to** 回归, 回到
- prewar adj. 战前的
- moral education 道德教育, 德育

6. 原文: Last year Mitsuo Setoyama, who was then education minister, raised eyebrows when he argued that liberal reforms introduced by the American occupation authorities after World War II had weakened the "Japanese morality of respect for parents."

○ 译文: 去年, 时任文部大臣的濑户光夫发表言论称, 二战后美国占领当局推行的自由主义改革, 削弱了“日本人尊敬父母的道德观”, 这番言论引发了舆论哗然。

○ 常考单词&短语:

- then adj. 当时的, 时任的
- education minister (日本) 文部大臣, 教育大臣
- 固定搭配 **raise eyebrows** 令人侧目, 引发哗然, 使人们吃惊
- argue v. 认为, 主张; 争论, 辩论 (此处为“认为”, 考研高频熟词生义)
- liberal reform 自由主义改革
- introduce v. 推行, 引入, 介绍
- occupation n. 占领, 占据
- authority n. 当局, 官方; 权威
- World War II 第二次世界大战
- weaken v. 削弱, 减弱
- morality n. 道德, 道德观
- 固定搭配 **respect for** 对...的尊敬/尊重

○ 长难句结构分析:

本句为多重复合句, 主句主干为 **Mitsuo Setoyama raised eyebrows**。**who** 引导非限制性定语从句, 修饰先行词 **Mitsuo Setoyama**, 补充说明其时任教育大臣的身份。**when** 引导时间状语从句, 从句主干为 **he argued that...**; **that** 引导宾语从句作 **argued** 的宾语, 该宾语从句主干为 **liberal reforms had weakened the "Japanese morality of respect for parents"**; 过去分词短语

introduced by the American occupation authorities after world war II 作后置定语，修饰 liberal reforms。

本段核心概括

本段分析了价值观衰退的第二个核心原因：日本应试教育体系过度强调应试与机械学习，长期忽视个性、创造力、人文素养等核心素养的培养，由此引发学生的强烈挫败感，最终导致校园暴力事件频发；同时指出日本保守派将该社会问题归咎于二战后美国推行的自由主义改革，呼吁回归战前的道德教育模式。

第四段

逐句翻译、词汇与长难句分析

1. 原文：But that may have more to do with Japanese life-styles.

- 译文：但这一现象或许与日本人的生活方式有着更大的关联。
- 常考单词&短语：
 - 固定搭配 **have more to do with** 与...有更大的关系，更多与...相关
 - life-style n. 生活方式

2. 原文：“In Japan,” says educator Yoko Muro, “it’s never a question of whether you enjoy your job and your life, but only how much you can endure.”

- 译文：“在日本，”教育学家室洋子说道，“问题从来都不在于你是否享受你的工作与生活，而只在于你能承受多少。”
- 常考单词&短语：
 - educator n. 教育学家，教育工作者
 - 固定句型 **it's never a question of...but only...** 问题从来不是...，而只是...
 - whether conj. 是否
 - endure v. 忍受，承受，忍耐

3. 原文：With economic growth has come centralization; fully 76 percent of Japan’s 119 million citizens live in cities where community and the extended family have been abandoned in favor of isolated, two-generation households.

- 译文：伴随着经济发展，日本出现了人口集中化的现象；日本1.19亿国民中，足足有76%的人居住在城市，在城市里，社区与大家庭模式已然被抛弃，取而代之的是孤立的核心家庭（两代人家庭）。
- 常考单词&短语：
 - economic growth 经济增长，经济发展
 - centralization n. 集中化，中心化（此处指人口向城市集中）
 - fully adv. 足足，整整；完全地
 - citizen n. 公民，国民，市民
 - community n. 社区，社群
 - extended family 大家庭（几代同堂的家庭模式）
 - abandon v. 抛弃，放弃，摒弃
 - 固定搭配 **in favor of** 转而选择，青睐，支持
 - isolated adj. 孤立的，隔绝的
 - two-generation households 两代人家庭，核心家庭

◦ 长难句结构分析：

本句由分号连接两个并列分句。第一个分句 **with economic growth has come centralization** 为完全倒装句，正常语序为 **Centralization has come with economic growth**，将with引导的伴随状语提前，句子完全倒装以起到强调作用。第二个分句主干为 **fully 76 percent of Japan’s 119 million citizens live in cities**；**where** 引导定语从句修饰先行词 **cities**，从句主干为

community and the extended family have been abandoned, in favor of isolated, two-generation households 为状语，说明被抛弃后取而代之的家庭模式。

4. 原文：Urban Japanese have long endured lengthy commutes (travels to and from work) and crowded living conditions, but as the old group and family values weaken, the discomfort is beginning to tell.

- 译文：城市里的日本人长期以来都忍受着漫长的通勤（上下班往返的路程）与拥挤的居住环境，但随着传统的集体与家庭价值观逐渐弱化，这种不适感开始显现出负面影响。
- 常考单词&短语：
 - urban adj. 城市的，都市的
 - lengthy adj. 漫长的，冗长的
 - commute n. 通勤，上下班路程
 - crowded adj. 拥挤的
 - living conditions 居住环境，生活条件
 - weaken v. 弱化，减弱
 - discomfort n. 不适感，不舒服
 - 固定搭配 begin to tell 开始显现效果，开始产生负面影响

5. 原文：In the past decade, the Japanese divorce rate, while still well below that of the United States, has increased by more than 50 percent, and suicides have increased by nearly one-quarter.

- 译文：在过去十年间，日本的离婚率尽管仍远低于美国，却已经上涨了超过50%，自杀率也上涨了近四分之一。
- 常考单词&短语：
 - decade n. 十年
 - divorce rate 离婚率
 - 固定搭配 well below 远低于
 - 固定搭配 increase by 增长了...（后接涨幅，考研高频考点）
 - nearly adv. 几乎，将近
 - one-quarter 四分之一
 - suicide n. 自杀，自杀率
- 长难句结构分析：

本句为 and 连接的并列复合句。前半分句主干为 the Japanese divorce rate has increased by more than 50 percent; while still well below that of the United States 为插入语作让步状语，完整结构为 while it is still well below that of the United States, 其中 that 指代前文的 divorce rate, 避免重复。后半分句 and suicides have increased by nearly one-quarter 与前半分句构成并列结构。

本段核心概括

本段指出日本社会问题的核心诱因，与日本人的生活方式有着更大的关联：经济发展带来的城市化，让日本人告别了传统社群与大家庭模式，长期承受着漫长通勤与拥挤居住环境的压力，而传统价值观的弱化让这种长期积压的压力的负面影响彻底显现，最终导致日本离婚率与自杀率大幅攀升。

三、完整原文

Aimlessness has hardly been typical of the postwar Japan whose productivity and social harmony are the envy of the United States and Europe. But increasingly the Japanese are seeing a decline of the traditional work-moral values. Ten years ago young people were hardworking and saw their jobs as their primary reason for being, but now Japan has largely fulfilled its economic needs, and young people don't know where they should go next.

The coming of age of the postwar baby boom and an entry of women into the male-dominated job market have limited the opportunities of teen-agers who are already questioning the heavy personal sacrifices involved in climbing Japan's rigid social ladder to good schools and jobs. In a recent survey, it was found that only 24.5 percent of Japanese students were fully satisfied with school life, compared with 67.2 percent of students in the United States. In addition, far more Japanese workers expressed dissatisfaction with their jobs than did their counterparts in the 10 other countries surveyed.

While often praised by foreigners for its emphasis on the basics, Japanese education tends to stress test taking and mechanical learning over creativity and self-expression. "Those things that do not show up in the test scores — personality, ability, courage or humanity — are completely ignored," says Toshiki Kaifu, chairman of the ruling Liberal Democratic Party's education committee. "Frustration against this kind of thing leads kids to drop out and run wild." Last year Japan experienced 2,125 incidents of school violence, including 929 assaults on teachers. Amid the outcry, many conservative leaders are seeking a return to the prewar emphasis on moral education. Last year Mitsuo Setoyama, who was then education minister, raised eyebrows when he argued that liberal reforms introduced by the American occupation authorities after World War II had weakened the "Japanese morality of respect for parents."

But that may have more to do with Japanese life-styles. "In Japan," says educator Yoko Muro, "it's never a question of whether you enjoy your job and your life, but only how much you can endure." With economic growth has come centralization; fully 76 percent of Japan's 119 million citizens live in cities where community and the extended family have been abandoned in favor of isolated, two-generation households. Urban Japanese have long endured lengthy commutes (travels to and from work) and crowded living conditions, but as the old group and family values weaken, the discomfort is beginning to tell. In the past decade, the Japanese divorce rate, while still well below that of the United States, has increased by more than 50 percent, and suicides have increased by nearly one-quarter.

四、完整译文

漫无目标几乎从来都不是战后日本的典型特征，其生产力水平与社会和谐程度令美国和欧洲各国艳羡不已。但如今，日本人正愈发见证着传统工作道德价值观的衰退。十年前，年轻人勤奋肯干，将工作视为自己生存的首要意义，但如今，日本的经济需求已基本得到满足，年轻人却不知道接下来该何去何从。

战后婴儿潮一代步入成年，加之女性进入原本由男性主导的就业市场，这两大因素限制了青少年的发展机会，而这些青少年已然在质疑，为了攀上日本通往好学校、好工作的僵化社会阶梯，所要付出的沉重个人代价是否值得。近期一项调查显示，仅有24.5%的日本学生对校园生活完全满意，而美国学生的这一比例高达67.2%。此外，与其他10个被调查国家的从业者相比，对自身工作表示不满的日本劳动者数量要多得多。

尽管日本的教育因重视基础教育而常受到外国人的称赞，但它往往更强调应试和机械性学习，而非创造力与自我表达能力的培养。“那些无法在考试分数中体现出来的东西——个性、能力、勇气或是人文素养——被完全忽视了，”日本执政的自由民主党教育委员会主席海部俊树说道。“对这种情况的挫败感，会导致孩子们辍学、肆意妄为。”去年，日本共发生了2125起校园暴力事件，其中包括929起袭击教师的案件。在一片抗议声中，许多保守派领导人正寻求回归战前对道德教育的重视模式。去年，时任文部大臣的濑户光夫发表言论称，二战后美国占领当局推行的自由主义改革，削弱了“日本人尊敬父母的道德观”，这番言论引发了舆论哗然。

但这一现象或许与日本人的生活方式有着更大的关联。“在日本，”教育学家室洋子说道，“问题从来都不在于你是否享受你的工作与生活，而只在于你能承受多少。”伴随着经济发展，日本出现了人口集中化的现象；日本1.19亿国民中，足足有76%的人居住在城市，在城市里，社区与大家庭模式已然被抛弃，取而代之的是孤立的核心家庭（两代人家庭）。城市里的日本人长期以来都忍受着漫长的通勤（上下班往返的路程）与拥挤的居住环境，但随着传统的集体与家庭价值观逐渐弱化，这种不适感开始显现出负面影响。在过去十年间，日本的离婚率尽管仍远低于美国，却已经上涨了超过50%，自杀率也上涨了近四分之一。